F5 Daily Briefing – Tuesday, October 13, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22	26	15	5
COMPETITORS TRACKED	ANNOUNCEMENTS	ACTIVE	ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



- Cisco (4)
- Cloudflare (3)
- AWS (3)
- Palo Alto Networks (2)
- Fortinet (2)
- CrowdStrike (2)
- Check Point Software (2)
- Zscaler (1)
- Pillar Security (1)
- Mindgard (1)
- Fastly (1)
- Citrix (NetScaler) (1)
- Radware (1)
- Barracuda Networks (1)
- Akamai (1)

Announcements by Category



- Platforms (11)
- AI Security (5)
- AI Data Delivery (5)
- Application Security (3)
- Application Delivery (ADCs) (2)

ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (26)

Customer Win **Palo Alto Networks** Oct 13, 2026

NHS England picks Palo Alto Networks and IBM for the next generation of its Secure Boundary programme

Palo Alto Networks and IBM announced the next phase of the NHS Secure Boundary programme. It provides cloud-based perimeter security, with IBM Consulting handling guidance and onboarding for organizations across UK health and social care. The programme covers more than 1.5 million NHS staff and more than 200 trusts. This is a major public-sector reference win for Palo Alto's cloud-delivered network security. It shows the vendor packaging security with a systems integrator for large public-sector rollouts.

https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/2026/10/nhs-england-evolves-its-cybersecurity-strategy-with-palo-alto-networks/

Research Palo Alto Networks Oct 13, 2026

Ransomware groups exploiting GlobalProtect authentication bypass CVE-2026-0257

Reports on October 13 said CVE-2026-0257 is being actively exploited by the Qilin and Settra ransomware groups. The flaw is an authentication bypass in the PAN-OS GlobalProtect portal and gateway, and in some Prisma Access configurations. It lets attackers open VPN sessions without valid credentials (CVSS 7.8). Palo Alto released a fix in May 2026. Affected PAN-OS trains include 12.1, 11.2, 11.1 and 10.2. Expect customers to ask about how secure the VPN and remote-access edge is.

https://blog.openvpn.net/palo-alto-globalprotect-cve-2026-0257-ransomware

Product Update Fortinet Oct 13, 2026

FortiOS product family achieves IEC 62443 certification

Fortinet announced IEC 62443 certification for the whole FortiOS product family. This covers FortiGate, FortiGate Rugged, FortiWiFi and FortiGate VM in every form factor. The certification spans FortiOS v7.4.x, v7.6.x and v8.x.x at Security Level 4. Development follows a secure product development lifecycle at IEC 62443-4-1 ML2 maturity. The certification strengthens Fortinet's position in OT, critical infrastructure and industrial control systems, where independent validation is often required to buy.

https://www.fortinet.com/blog/operational-technology/fortinet-achieves-iec-62443-certification-across-the-fortios-product-family

Research Fortinet Oct 13, 2026

Fortinet patches critical unauthenticated flaws in FortiSandbox and FortiSIEM

Fortinet's monthly PSIRT release had 10 advisories covering 13 vulnerabilities across eight product lines. Two are critical and need no authentication: a FortiSandbox GUI authentication bypass, CVE-2026-107656 (CVSS 9.6), and a FortiSIEM 7.5.0 path-traversal flaw allowing remote code execution, CVE-2026-106173. FortiAnalyzer, FortiManager and FortiMail were also patched. The release follows the FortiBleed credential-harvesting campaign against FortiGate earlier in October, adding to questions about Fortinet's security-operations and edge infrastructure.

https://securityonline.info/fortinet-vulnerabilities-fortisandbox-fortisiem/

Product Update Cisco Oct 13, 2026

Splunk details three foundation models for machine-data analysis

Splunk published details of three specialized foundation models that analyze machine data and surface useful signals at lower compute cost and latency. One is the Cisco Deep Time Series Model, which finds unusual time-series behavior without training on each metric. Splunk says early deployments showed fewer false positives and faster detection. The models support Cisco's AI-native observability and SOC story across Splunk.

https://www.splunk.com/en_us/blog/artificial-intelligence/splunk-foundation-models-help-teams-find-the-signals-that-matter.html

Acquisition CrowdStrike Oct 13, 2026

CrowdStrike discloses about $586M price for XM Cyber technology acquisition

CrowdStrike disclosed that it closed its purchase of XM Cyber's technology assets from Schwarz Group. Total consideration is about $586 million, including roughly 2.12 million shares issued at closing. CrowdStrike gets XM Cyber's source code and more than 45 patents, but not its customers or revenue; XM Cyber continues as a standalone company under license. CrowdStrike gains attack-path and exposure-management technology for Falcon, alongside a sovereign-cloud partnership on Schwarz Digits' STACKIT in Europe.

https://www.calcalistech.com/ctechnews/article/sje00evoizx

Research CrowdStrike Oct 13, 2026

CrowdStrike helps the FBI disrupt DPRK FAMOUS CHOLLIMA laptop farms

CrowdStrike said its Counter Adversary Operations team helped the FBI disrupt U.S.-based laptop farms used by the North Korea-linked group FAMOUS CHOLLIMA. The scheme used fake remote IT workers to send wages back to the regime while keeping access to victim networks. CrowdStrike identified personas, indicators of compromise and facilitator infrastructure. The case strengthens CrowdStrike's threat-intelligence and public-sector credibility.

https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/blog/fbi-disrupts-famous-chollima-operation-with-crowdstrike-assistance/

Partnership Zscaler Oct 13, 2026

Zscaler signs Malaysia distribution deal with LinkAxia Networks

Zscaler signed a distribution agreement with LinkAxia Networks to sell its Zero Trust Exchange platform through LinkAxia's partner network in Malaysia. The deal is aimed at public-sector and government-linked organizations. It covers secure remote access, cloud/SaaS security and data protection across web, cloud and AI apps. It builds on Zscaler's January 2026 launch of a Kuala Lumpur data center and supports Malaysia's National Cyber Security Baseline goals.

https://www.channelinsider.com/channel-business/zscaler-linkaxia-malaysia-distribution-deal/

Research Check Point Software Oct 13, 2026

NSS Labs 2026 Cloud Network Firewall Test: Check Point posts highest security effectiveness

In NSS Labs' 2026 Cloud Network Firewall test, Check Point had the highest overall Security Effectiveness at 99.95%, including 100% malware blocking and 100% evasion resistance. It received only a Neutral rating because of its higher cost per protected Mbps ($32.52). Fortinet, HPE Juniper, Palo Alto Networks and Versa scored between 99.74% and 99.91%. NSS Labs argues that native cloud firewalls are convenient but not as effective.

https://nsslabs.com/media/blog/native-cloud-firewalls-are-convenient-convenience-is-not-security-effectiveness/

Product Update Cloudflare Oct 13, 2026

Cloudflare Gateway adds opt-in DNS64 via DNS locations and EDNS

Cloudflare Gateway, part of its Zero Trust/SASE platform, now lets customers request DNS64 through DNS locations and EDNS. Organizations can turn on DNS64 translation for IPv6-only networks using Gateway's DNS filtering.

https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/2026-10-13-gateway-dns64-opt-in/

Research Pillar Security Oct 13, 2026

Pillar Security discovers 'BadEngram,' exposing hidden supply-chain risk in open-weight AI models

Pillar Security and Fujitsu researchers disclosed BadEngram, a supply-chain backdoor attack on open-weight AI models that use gated memory, including Qwen3.8-Flash-Next and DeepSeek-V4.1-Flash. The attack changes only the memory components, such as memory tables, gates and projections, and leaves the rest of the model untouched. The backdoor stays dormant until a short trigger activates it, so standard testing rarely catches it. Pillar says organizations should verify the integrity and provenance of every learned component when models are converted, quantized, repackaged or sourced from third parties.

https://www.globenewswire.com/news-release/2026/10/13/3379584/0/en/pillar-security-discovers-badengram-exposing-hidden-supply-chain-risk-in-open-weight-ai-models.html

Research Mindgard Oct 13, 2026

BRANCH: Bypassing multi-scanner AI guardrails

Mindgard and Lancaster University published BRANCH, a tree-search method for evading stacks of multiple AI guardrail scanners by perturbing inputs to beat one scanner at a time. In testing it bypassed six guardrail systems in all 120 scenarios, using 72% fewer queries than earlier techniques. The bypasses also worked against 29 of 32 guardrails it had not been tuned on, including eight commercial products, raising single-shot evasion by 32.9 percentage points on average. Mindgard says layered guardrails need ongoing adversarial testing.

https://mindgard.ai/blog/branch-bypassing-multi-scanner-ai-guardrails

Partnership Fastly Oct 13, 2026

Fastly expands partnership with Jio Platforms to power JioCDN for India's digital economy

Fastly expanded its partnership with Jio Platforms Limited to upgrade JioCDN, a content delivery network built on Jio's 5G and fixed broadband network and powered by Fastly's programmable edge cloud. JioCDN has carried live streams for the IPL and the ICC T20 World Cup 2026. It also serves Reliance properties including JioHotstar, AJIO and JioTV. The companies say it is priced for the Indian market and can support tens of millions of concurrent viewers.

https://www.fastly.com/press/press-releases/fastly-expands-partnership-with-jio-platforms

Other Citrix (NetScaler) Oct 13, 2026

Critical NetScaler ADC/Gateway RCE flaw CVE-2026-107406 (CVSS 9.5) draws fresh advisories

An October 13 eSecurityPlanet report covered CVE-2026-107406, a critical memory overflow flaw (CVSS 9.5) in NetScaler ADC and NetScaler Gateway. On appliances set up as a SAML IdP or SP, it can allow remote code execution or denial of service. Citrix's bulletin and patches came out October 8, and CISA issued an advisory October 12. On October 13, Taiwan CERT also flagged actively exploited NetScaler CVE-2026-88771/88772, and NZ NCSC updated its alert.

https://www.esecurityplanet.com/threats/news-citrix-netscaler-rce-cve-2026-107406/

Research Radware Oct 13, 2026

Radware blog: layered suppression for AppWall under attack

Radware posted a technical blog by David Cohen on layered suppression strategies for defending its AppWall web application firewall during active attacks. The post explains how layered suppression reduces attack traffic while keeping legitimate users able to reach the application. It also covers best practices, deployment considerations, and the effect on application availability and security posture.

https://www.radware.com/blog/layered-suppression-for-appwall-under-attack/

Product Update Barracuda Networks Oct 13, 2026

Barracuda redesigns Trust Center with Due Diligence Navigator and Bailey AI assistant

Barracuda redesigned its Trust Center to put security, compliance, certification, and product information in one place for customers, MSPs, and partners. New tools include a Due Diligence Navigator and the Bailey AI assistant, which are meant to speed up security due-diligence reviews. Barracuda says early feedback shows faster deal progress and easier ongoing compliance work.

https://blog.barracuda.com/2026/10/13/barracuda-trust-center-faster-value

Product Launch Cisco Oct 13, 2026

Cisco and NVIDIA unveil USFP ultra-dense pluggable optics for Ethernet AI fabrics

At the OCP Global Summit 2026, Cisco and NVIDIA introduced USFP (Ultra-Dense Small Form Factor Pluggable) optics. The modules run at 400 Gb/s per lane, with up to 12.8 Tbps of total capacity for Ethernet AI fabrics. Cisco also announced that Silicon One G300 is sampling, plus SONiC with Nexus One and a new out-of-band management system. Together these support Cisco's full-stack story for AI factory networks, from silicon to network OS.

https://www.networkworld.com/article/4233992/cisco-nvidia-push-ultra-dense-networking-for-ethernet-ai-fabrics.html

Product Launch Cisco Oct 13, 2026

Cisco adds Tokenomics to Splunk Agent Observability to track AI spend

Cisco announced Tokenomics, a capability in Splunk Agent Observability that tracks AI token spending in real time. It combines usage across tools such as Claude Code and Codex and across model providers, and uses the Cisco Deep Time Series Model to forecast future spend. Teams can assign usage to business outcomes and route workloads to cheaper models. It is available through Cisco Cloud Control and Splunk Observability, on-premises and in the cloud. This puts Cisco into AI traffic cost governance.

https://www.zawya.com/en/press-release/companies-news/cisco-highlights-how-ai-tokenomics-can-help-organizations-manage-ai-costs-at-scale-1615780

Product Update Cisco Oct 13, 2026

Cisco AI Defense adds Agent Runtime Protection for AI agents

Cisco added Agent Runtime Protection to the AI Defense Python SDK. A single agentsec.protect() call wraps LLM prompts, responses and MCP tool calls in AI Defense inspection, with no changes to application code. It targets tool poisoning, indirect prompt injection and data exfiltration. It supports LangChain, LangGraph, CrewAI, the OpenAI Agents SDK and Google ADK, plus AWS Bedrock AgentCore, Vertex AI and Azure AI Foundry, in API and gateway modes. This competes directly with F5 AI Guardrails for agent runtime security.

https://dailysynapse.com/news/cisco-adds-runtime-protection-for-ai-agents/

Research Check Point Software Oct 13, 2026

Check Point Research discovers high-risk vulnerabilities in LiteLLM LLM gateway

Check Point Research disclosed two high-risk vulnerabilities in LiteLLM, an open-source LLM gateway with about 97 million downloads a month. CVE-2026-35029 let even read-only users reach admin functions. CVE-2026-59823 let attackers redirect gateway requests to their own server and steal AI provider API keys. In controlled testing, the flaws enabled full system takeover, credential theft and remote code execution. Both are fixed in LiteLLM 1.83.9 and later.

https://blog.checkpoint.com/security/check-point-research-discovers-high-risk-vulnerabilities-in-litellm-one-of-the-most-widely-used-llm-gateways/

Product Update Cloudflare Oct 13, 2026

Workers subrequests now preserve context for BYOIP destinations

Cloudflare now treats Workers subrequests to Bring Your Own IP (BYOIP) destinations as Cloudflare-to-Cloudflare traffic. The CF-Worker header and upstream zone context are kept, so security rules evaluate the same way across zones. Bot Management now reports the original end-user connection, with accurate bot scores and JA3/JA4 fingerprints, instead of the internal service connection. No configuration change is needed.

https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/2026-10-13-byoip-workers-subrequest-context/

Product Update Cloudflare Oct 13, 2026

Cloudflare API MCP server sends Workers Issues as MCP events

Cloudflare's API MCP server now pushes production issues from Workers to subscribed MCP clients as signed events. AI coding agents and operators get real-time alerts on new or recurring failures without polling. This extends Workers Issues, the open-beta error-monitoring feature that groups production failures and can route them to coding agents such as Claude Code, Cursor or Devin.

https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/2026-10-13-cloudflare-mcp-events/

Product Update AWS Oct 13, 2026

AWS Agent Registry now supports custom metadata for registry records

AWS Agent Registry now supports custom metadata schemas for each registry. Fields can hold team ownership, data classification or review status as text, URLs, booleans or predefined choices. The registry checks required fields on create and update. Users can filter by custom metadata in the Console, CLI, SDKs and the MCP endpoint, which helps govern discovery of AI agents and tools. It is available in N. Virginia, Oregon, Sydney, Tokyo and Ireland.

https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/10/aws-agent-registry-custom-metadata-registry-records/

Product Update AWS Oct 13, 2026

AWS Weekly Roundup: Claude Haiku 5.5 on Bedrock, GuardDuty RDS Protection expansion, Continuum pen testing preview

The AWS News Blog roundup for October 13 covers Claude Haiku 5.5 on Amazon Bedrock, with new effort controls for trading cost against intelligence in agent workloads. Amazon GuardDuty RDS Protection now detects data exfiltration and destructive queries on Aurora and RDS PostgreSQL. AWS Continuum for Penetration Testing entered public preview, adding pen testing to CI/CD pipelines. Amazon Nova 2.5 Sonic for voice agents was also highlighted.

https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/aws/aws-weekly-roundup-prime-day-2026-by-the-numbers-claude-haiku-5-5-amazon-nova-2-5-sonic-and-more-october-13-2026/

Product Launch AWS Oct 13, 2026

AI/ML skill in Agent Toolkit for AWS brings SageMaker AI expertise to coding agents

AWS added an AI/ML skill to the Agent Toolkit for AWS. It lets coding agents select, train, optimize and deploy SageMaker AI models through natural-language workflows. It covers inference optimization, model customization, training, MLflow lifecycle management, JumpStart deployment and processing jobs. The skill is free (customers pay for the underlying resources) and comes pre-installed in SageMaker Studio JupyterLab.

https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/10/bring-sagemaker-ai-expertise-to-your-coding-agent/

Other Akamai Oct 13, 2026

Akamai signs 13 MW rooftop solar virtual PPA with EDP in Singapore

Akamai signed a virtual power purchase agreement with EDP Asia-Pacific for up to 13 MWp of rooftop solar capacity across 27 operating sites in Singapore. The sites can generate about 17,000 MWh a year. The deal supports Akamai's goal of using 100% renewable energy and reaching net-zero emissions by 2030, and fits Singapore's Green Plan 2030.

https://renewablesnow.com/news/akamai-inks-vppa-for-13-mwp-of-singapores-rooftop-solar-arrays-1302899/